

Later, of my own free will, I gave up my association with *Golden Rule Magazine*. Did I then wish I had accepted Ivy Lee's offer? Not at all. My name and my career remained my own. I retained and still retain the right to travel under my own name in any direction I wish to go, assuming full responsibility for my mistakes, taking full credit for my successes.

People told me at the time that I had made a great mistake in turning down that handsome offer, and even urged me to get in touch with Mr. Lee and see if the offer still was open. If indeed it had been a mistake, I told myself, I had only to remember that every misfortune carries within it the seed of a greater benefit. And when I look back at what I have accomplished by way of extending the secrets of happiness and life-success over a large portion of the world, I see that only in being myself have I succeeded in being successful.

Today—right now—start doing all you can toward being yourself. As you enter a clothing store, or a restaurant or any other establishment in which you will be served—in exchange for your money—decide firmly and quietly that you are going to be yourself. In your talks with others, in your own personal dealings, in whatever you may do that is shared with others or affects others—be yourself. I mention other people because it is most often in our relations with others that we neglect to be ourselves—and you can be completely yourself, and appreciated for what you are, while you still respect the rights of others.

In the Foreword I listed a number of blessings which are associated with peace of mind. I pointed out that peace of mind is the peaceful base upon which we erect a good deal of life-dynamic. Now, somewhat overlapping the same list and somewhat extending it, I am going to set down forty-three items which pertain to being yourself. Few people will recognize themselves completely in this list, but if you will take a pencil and check each item that you sincerely believe applies to *you*, it will be most revealing.

1. The man who consistently is himself maintains his poise under all circumstances, whether the circumstances are favorable or unfavorable.
2. He has control of his emotions at all times.
3. He has perfect self-reliance and self-confidence in everything he undertakes.